



**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of AMERICA
Giving Purpose to Potential



CONTEMPORARY ISSUES

(530)

NATIONAL 2023

FINAL

Presentation Points	_____ (160 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (180 points)

Preparation Time: 10 minutes

Description

Demonstrate communication skills in arranging, organizing, and effectively presenting information orally without prior knowledge of the topic.

No materials or previously prepared notes will be allowed into the preparation or presentation room with the contestant.

JUDGING PROCEDURE

- The contestant will draw two (2) different business topics and will select either one. The topics may deal with Business Professionals of America, office situations, the business world, etc.
- The contestant will be provided ten (10) minutes to develop the topic. Notes will be made on the note cards provided by the event proctor. No advisor contact will be allowed between the time of receiving the topic and the delivery.
- Cell phones may not be used in the preparation room.
- Contestants will be introduced by contestant number. **Contestants may continue to wear their name badges.**
- Contestants will present before a panel of judges and timekeeper.
- The length of the speech will be no less three (3) minutes and no more than five (5) minutes.
- The contestant will be given warnings via flash cards when there are two (2) minutes remaining and when there is one (1) minute remaining during the speaking time.
- The speech will be stopped at five (5) minutes.
- No time is allotted for judges' questions.
- Contestants should be dismissed upon completion of their speech.
- **There can be no ties in the top ten (10) contestants.** It is the responsibility of the judges to break any ties.
- Administrator will fill out ranking sheet prior to dismissing the judges.
- If more than one (1) section is necessary, finalists will be determined by selecting an equal number from each section.
- Give administrator all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets, and contest materials.
- No audience is allowed in the contest room.

Please double-check and verify all scores!

TOPICS:

Should protesters be legally allowed to block a freeway? What are the implications?

If the government decided to pay off student loan debt, who should qualify and why?

Describe situations where companies should prohibit employee cell phone use in the workplace.

How should schools include LGTBQ+ as part of their diversity and inclusion policies?

Should previous US Presidents make public comments on existing President's policies?

What should be done to combat sexual harassment in the workplace?